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Crazy rich Asians

摘金奇缘

难度评级: ★★★☆☆

How AI-fuelled wealth is reshaping South Korea

AI 创造的财富如何重塑韩国

【 Para.1 】

An **unkempt** man walks into a **pricey** shop. The staff **dismiss** him—until he takes off his jacket and reveals a **gilet** **emblazoned** with “SK Hynix”, a **semiconductor** firm known for **handing out** massive bonuses. This imagined scene—a recent **skit** on a South Korean comedy show—**lampoons** real ones **unfolding** as AI-driven wealth floods the country. Companies that help arrange marriages report a big jump in the **desirability** of engineers from SK Hynix and Samsung Electronics, another semiconductor-maker. They are now nearly as **sought after** as doctors and lawyers.

一位衣衫不整的男子走进一家高档商店。店员对他态度冷淡，直到他脱下夹克，露出一件印有“SK海力士”标志的背心。这家半导体公司以发放巨额奖金著称。这一虚构场景出自韩国一档喜剧综艺近期播出的

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文章导读：

AI 浪潮带来的红利正在重塑韩国社会，三星、SK 海力士等芯片厂商利润激增，催生高薪“硅领”从业者，但收益高度集中于半导体行业。韩国股市大幅震荡，政府税收显著增加。各界围绕芯片企业超额利润分配产生激烈争论，部分人呼吁财富再分配，另一派则担忧额外征税会阻碍产业持续投入。

crazy rich Asians n. 电影名《摘金奇缘》，好莱坞著名电影，使用电影片名能立刻唤起读者对亚洲富豪的认知，同时“摘金”巧妙地与文章的“淘金热”主题（镐和铲、挖矿）联系起来

reshape v. /ˈriːˈʃeɪp/ to change the shape or structure of sth 改变...的形状（或结构）；重塑；改组

unkempt adj. /ˌʌnˈkempt/ (especially of sb's hair or general appearance 尤指头发或外貌) not well cared for; not neat or tidy 不整洁的；凌乱的；不修边幅的

pricey adj. /ˈpraɪsi/ expensive 昂贵的
Medical insurance is very **pricey**. 医疗保险很昂贵。

dismiss v. ~ sb/sth (as sth) to decide that sb/sth is not important and not worth thinking or talking about 不予考虑；摒弃；对...不屑一提 【考研大纲词汇】

SYN wave aside

I think we can safely **dismiss** their objections. 我认为我们对他们的异议完全可以不予理会。

gilet n. /ˈɡɪlə/ a light thick jacket without sleeves 厚夹克背心

emblazoned adj. /ˈmbleɪzənd/ if something is emblazoned with a design, words, or letters, they are clearly drawn, printed, or sewn on it (绘制的图案或文字等) 用纹章装饰的

semiconductor n. a solid substance that conducts electricity in particular conditions, better than insulators but not as well as conductors 半导体 【考研大纲词汇】

hand out phrase if you hand things out to people, you give one or more to each person in a group 分发

skit n. ~ (on sth) a short piece of humorous writing or a performance that makes fun of sb/sth by copying them 幽默短文，滑稽短剧，幽默讽刺小品（常用模仿手法）

a **skit on** daytime TV programmes 戏评日间电视节目的幽默短文

lampoon v. /læmˈpuːn/ to criticize sb/sth publicly in an amusing way that makes them or it look ridiculous 嘲讽；讥讽

His cartoons mercilessly **lampooned** the politicians of his time. 他的漫画毫不留情地嘲讽了他那个年代的政治人物。

unfold v. to be gradually made known; to gradually make sth known to other people (使) 逐渐展现；展示；透露 【考研大纲词汇】

The audience watched as the story **unfolded** before their eyes. 观众注视着剧情逐渐地展开。

小品，讽刺了随着AI驱动型财富涌入韩国而真实上演的景象。婚介公司报告称，SK海力士与三星电子（另一家半导体制造商）的工程师在婚恋市场上的吸引力大幅跃升，如今几乎与医生和律师同样受青睐。

【 Para.2 】

An AI **windfall** is reshaping South Korean society. Speaking in Silicon Valley on July 25th, Lee Jae Myung, South Korea's president, compared the AI era to the discovery of fire and called it "a truly new opportunity for Korea". But the new era also brings risks: South Korea's **benchmark** stock index, KOSPI, has doubled in value in the past year but **dipped** 22% in July. A series of wild swings have made it the most **volatile** stock market in the world.

AI带来的意外之财正在重塑韩国社会。韩国总统李在明（Lee Jae Myung）7月25日在硅谷发表演讲，将AI时代比作火的发现，并称之为“韩国真正的新机遇”。但新时代亦伴随风险：韩国基准股指KOSPI在过去一年翻了一番，却在7月份下跌了22%。一系列剧烈波动使其成为全球波动性最大的股票市场。

【 Para.3 】

Fierce debates **rage** in Seoul over how to ensure that new wealth is shared **equitably** and **stewarded** sustainably. "This raises a new policy challenge for us: how should we **approach** such extraordinary excess profits from a socioeconomic perspective and from the standpoint of

desirability n. /dɪˈzaɪərəˈbɪləti/ 欲求，希求；性感

seek after phrase 追求，追逐：努力寻找或追求某人或某物

windfall n. /ˈwɪndfɔːl/ an amount of money that sb/sth wins or receives unexpectedly 意外之财；意外获得的东西

benchmark n. something which can be measured and used as a standard that other things can be compared with 基准
Tests at the age of seven provide a **benchmark** against which the child's progress at school can be measured. 七岁时进行的测试为孩子在学校中的学习发展提供了一个测量基准。

dip v. to go downwards or to a lower level; to make sth do this (使) 下降，下沉 【考研大纲词汇】
SYN fall

The sun **dipped** below the horizon. 太阳落到地平线下了。
Sales for this quarter have **dipped** from 38.7 million to 33 million. 本季度销售额从3 870万下降到3 300万。

volatile adj. /ˈvɒlətaɪl/ (of a situation 情况) likely to change suddenly; easily becoming dangerous 可能急剧波动的；不稳定的；易恶化的
SYN unstable

rage v. /reɪdʒ/ ~ (on) (of a storm, a battle, an argument, etc. 暴风雨、战斗、争论等) to continue in a violent way 猛烈地继续；激烈进行 【考研大纲词汇】
The riots **raged** for three days. 暴乱持续了三天。

equitably adv. /ˈekwɪtəbli/ 公正地

Wealth was redistributed more **equitably** among society. 财富在社会上被更公平地重新分配。

steward v. /ˈstuːəd/ (of an official) supervise arrangements or keep order at (a large public event) (官员) 管理(大型公共事件) 【考研大纲词汇】
the event was organized and **stewarded** properly 那件事的组织和管理都恰当

approach v. to start dealing with a problem, task, etc. in a particular way 着手处理；对付 【考研大纲词汇】
What's the best way of **approaching** this problem? 什么是处理这个问题的最佳方式？

newfound adj. a newfound quality or ability is one that you have got recently 新得到的

infrastructure n. /ˈɪnfəstrʌktʃə(r)/ the basic systems and services that are necessary for a country or an organization to run smoothly, for example buildings, transport and water and power supplies (国家或机构的) 基础设施，基础设施建设 【考研大纲词汇】

bandwidth n. a band of frequencies used for sending electronic signals 带宽；频宽

chip n. chip technology 芯片科技 【考研大纲词汇】

picks and shovels n. 镐与平锹，一种挖掘和挖土工具，通常用于建筑、园艺或采矿等领域

gold rush phrase a situation when a lot of people suddenly go to a place where gold has been discovered 淘金热

hit v. if you hit a particular high or low point on a scale of something such as success or health, you reach it 达到
He admits to having **hit** the lowest point in his life. 他承认自己跌到了一生中的最低谷。

national policy?" Mr Lee said during an interview with The Economist in June. The following month his government announced a "Future Response Fund" to invest **newfound** tax revenue for generations to come.

在首尔，围绕如何确保新财富公平分配并以可持续方式进行管理的激烈辩论持续上演。“这给我们带来了新的政策挑战：从社会经济视角和国家政策立场出发，我们应如何对待这种超常的超额利润？”李在明6月接受《经济学人》采访时如是说。次月，其政府宣布了“未来应对基金”，将新增税收收入投资于子孙后代。

【 Para.4 】

Wealth is flowing into South Korea because its firms provide **infrastructure** AI model-makers need, such as high-**bandwidth** memory **chips**. South Korean officials speak of producing "**picks and shovels**" for an AI **gold rush**. While the gold miners may or may not **hit paydirt**, the pickmakers (or, rather, the chipmakers) are already **flush**. On July 30th Samsung Electronics said operating profit in the second quarter was 89.5trn **won** (\$63bn), up 1,800% from a year earlier. One day earlier SK Hynix said operating profit in the same quarter grew 557%, year on year.

财富之所以涌入韩国，是因为该国企业提供了AI模型制造商所需的基础设施，例如高带宽存储芯片。韩国官员称，他们正在为AI淘金热生产“镐和铲”。无论淘金者最终能否挖到金矿，造镐者（更确切地说是芯片制造商）已然获利丰厚。7月30日，三星电子公布第

paydirt n. if you say that someone has struck paydirt or has hit paydirt, you mean that they have achieved sudden success or gained a lot of money very quickly 突然成功；一夜暴富

flush adj. having a lot of money, usually for a short time 富有，很有钱（通常为短期的）【考研大纲词汇】

won n. /wʌn/ the standard monetary unit of South Korea, divided into 100 **chon** 圆；南韩货币单位，合100韩

set aside phrase if you set something aside for a special use or purpose, you keep it available for that use or purpose 省出；抽出

cut n. a share in sth, especially money (尤指钱的) 份，份额
They were rewarded with a cut of 5% from the profits. 他们得到了占利润5%份额的酬报。

ditch n. /dɪtʃ/ a long channel dug at the side of a field or road, to hold or take away water 沟；渠【考研大纲词汇】
last ditch 最后防线

stave off phrase if you stave off something bad, or if you stave it off, you succeed in stopping it from happening for a while 延缓

payout n. a large amount of money that is given to sb 付出的巨款

mint v. /mɪnt/ to make a coin from metal 铸（币）；铸造（硬币）

collar n. /'kɒlə(r)/ the part around the neck of a shirt, jacket or coat that usually folds down 衣领；领子【考研大纲词汇】

a coat with a fur **collar** 毛皮领大衣

He always wears a **collar** and tie for work. 他上班总是系着领带。

the spoils n. /spɔɪl/ [pl.] goods taken from a place by thieves or by an army that has won a battle or war 赃物；战利品；掠夺物【考研大纲词汇】

sluggish adj. moving, reacting or working more slowly than normal and in a way that seems lazy 缓慢的；迟缓的；懒洋洋的

equities n. /'ekwəti/ [pl.] (finance 财) shares in a company which do not pay a fixed amount of interest (公司的) 普通股

a piece of the action phrase a share or role in an interesting or exciting activity, especially in order to make money 插手，参与（尤指为了赚钱）

Foreign firms will all want a **piece of the action** if the new airport goes ahead. 要是新机场开始修建，外国公司都会来插一手捞好处。

fiscal adj. /'fɪsk(ə)l/ connected with government or public money, especially taxes 财政的；国库的；国家岁入的【考研大纲词汇】

coffers n. /'kɒfə(r)/ [pl.] a way of referring to the money that a government, an organization, etc. has available to spend (政府、机构等的) 金库，资金

taxation n. /tæk'seɪʃn/ money that has to be paid as taxes 税；税款；税金；税收

grapple v. /'græpl/ ~ (with sth) to try hard to find a solution to a problem 努力设法解决

The new government has yet to **grapple** with the problem of air pollution. 新政府还需尽力解决空气污染问题。

二季度营业利润为89.5万亿韩元（约合630亿美元），同比增长1800%。一天前，SK海力士公布同季度营业利润同比增长557%。

【 Para.5 】

Their workers want a bigger share. Last year SK Hynix agreed to **set aside** 10% of its operating profit for bonuses. Samsung's powerful labour union threatened a strike in May, demanding a **cut** of soaring profits. A last-**ditch** agreement **staved off** a factory shutdown; some bonuses will exceed \$400,000. Such **payouts** are unheard of in a country where the average annual salary is less than \$40,000. A new class of workers has been **minted**: neither white- nor blue-**collar**, but “silicon-collar”.

员工们希望获得更大份额。去年，SK海力士同意抽出营业利润的10%用于发放奖金。三星强大的工会5月曾威胁罢工，要求从暴涨的利润中分取更多份额。最后一刻达成的协议避免了工厂停工；部分奖金将超过40万美元。在一个年平均工资不足4万美元的国家，这样的薪酬水平前所未有。一个新的工人阶层由此诞生：既非白领亦非蓝领，而是“硅领”。

【 Para.6 】

Yet **the spoils** have largely been limited to chip-industry insiders. The government recently raised its GDP growth forecast for 2026 from 2% to 3%, but that is largely thanks to booming exports. Except near chip factories, consumption has been **sluggish**. People outside the industry

spark v. ~ sth (off) to cause sth to start or develop, especially suddenly 引发；触发 【考研大纲词汇】
The proposal would **spark** a storm of protest around the country. 这一提案将引发全国性的抗议浪潮。

muse v. /mju:z/ ~ (about/on/over/upon sth) to think carefully about sth for a time, ignoring what is happening around you 沉思；冥想
SYN ponder
I sat quietly, **mus**ing on the events of the day. 我静静地坐着，沉思一天中所发生的事。

dividend n. /'dividend/ an amount of the profits that a company pays to people who own shares in the company 红利；股息；股利
dividend payments of 50 cents a share 每股50分的股息支付

faction n. a small group of people within a larger one whose members have some different aims and beliefs to those of the larger group (大团体中的) 派系，派别，小集团
rival factions within the administration 政府中的对立派别

sweeping adj. having an important effect on a large part of sth 影响广泛的；大范围的；根本性的 【考研大纲词汇】

bracket n. /'brækit/ price, age, income, etc. ~prices, etc. within a particular range (价格、年龄、收入等的) 组级，等级 【考研大纲词汇】

levy n. /'levi/ a levy is a sum of money that you have to pay, for example, as a tax to the government 税款 【考研大纲词汇】

akin n. /ə'kin/ ~ to sth (formal) similar to 相似的；类似的
What he felt was more **akin** to pity than love. 他感受到的更像怜悯，而不是爱。

have looked to **equities** for **a piece of the action**. Retail investors poured 78trn won (\$54bn) into South Korean stocks in May and June; many were burned when shares fell in July.

然而，红利目前仅限于芯片行业内部人士。政府近期将2026年GDP增长预期从2%上调至3%，但这主要得益于出口的繁荣。除芯片工厂周边外，消费一直疲软。行业以外的人则将目光投向股市，以期参与其中。散户投资者在5月和6月向韩国股票投入了78万亿韩元（约合540亿美元）；许多人在7月股价下跌时遭受损失。

【Para.7】

The broadest benefit will be **fiscal**, as corporate and income-tax revenues flood government **coffers**. Corporate-tax receipts from Samsung and SK Hynix alone could yield as much as the government expected to receive in total from corporate **taxation** this year. Overall tax revenue is projected to reach 500trn won next year, equal to 17% of GDP and a record high.

最广泛的收益将主要体现在财政领域，因为企业和所得税收入充实国库。仅三星和SK海力士缴纳的公司税，就可能接近政府今年预期的所有公司税。明年总税收预计将达到500万亿韩元，相当于GDP的17%，创历史新高。

【Para.8】

➤ 今日句子分析

Para 4. While the gold miners may or may not hit paydirt, the pickmakers (or, rather, the chipmakers) are already flush.

让步状语从句

While the gold miners may or may not hit paydirt,

引导词 主语 谓语 宾语

主句

the pickmakers (or, rather, the chipmakers) are already

主语 插入语 系动词

flush.

表语

句子分析：

让步状语从句：

引导词-While；主语-the gold miners；谓语- may or may not hit；宾语-paydirt,

主句：

主语- the pickmakers；插入语（对主语 the pickmakers 进行补充说明，明确其实际所指）- (or, rather, the chipmakers)；系动词-are already；表语-flush.

翻译解析：句子整体结构是让步状语从句（While...）+ 主句（the pickmakers...），插入语嵌于主句主语之后，起同位解释作用。翻译难点在于文化比喻，熟悉创投的同学会比较熟悉。

“gold miners”与“pickmakers”源自美国西进运动时期的淘金热，比喻AI产业链中的不同角色：前者指AI模型开发商（如OpenAI），后者指提供基础硬件（芯片）的韩国企业。翻译策略是保留“淘金者”和“造锅者”这一对喻体，既形象又符合中文表达习惯。

还有俚语与口语化表达的书面转化：“hit paydirt”原指采矿时挖到含金的矿层，引申为“获得巨大成功或财富”，直接译作“挖到金矿”既保留了字面意义，又暗含比喻，读者能自然领会；“flush”是俚语，意为“富有的、资金充足的”，若直译“有钱”过于口语化，故选用较书面化的“获利丰厚”，既准确又符合本文财经报道的语体。

Policymakers are **grappling** with how to manage the windfall. Kim Yong-beom, Mr Lee's chief domestic-policy adviser, **sparked** debates in May with a personal Facebook post **musng** about a possible "citizen **dividend**" funded through excess tax revenues. Speaking to The Economist, Mr Lee suggested that a basic income could be one of several useful policy options.

政策制定者正在努力应对如何处置这笔意外之财。李在明的首席国内政策顾问金容范 (Kim Yong beom) 5月在个人社交媒体上发帖，思考通过超额税收收入向民众发放“公民分红”的可能性，引发广泛讨论。李在明在接受《经济学人》采访时表示，基本收入可能是若干有用政策选项之一。

【Para.9】

One **faction** is arguing for more **sweeping** redistribution. Chipmakers' success was made possible by "long-term public investment by the state and support from taxpayers and the public", and should be returned in part to the public, says Oh Jun-ho of the Basic Income Research Institute. Proposals include creating new top corporate-tax **brackets** for higher-earning companies, imposing windfall **levies**, or giving the public stakes in the firms.

一部分人主张进行更广泛的再分配。基本收入研究所的吴俊浩 (Oh Jun ho) 表示，芯片制造商的成功“离不开国家长期的公共投入以及纳税人和公众的支持”，因此应部分回馈公众。建议包括：为高盈利企业设立新的更高公司税税率、征收暴利税，或向公众

➤ 写作积累

Para.3 Fierce debates rage in Seoul over how to ensure that new wealth is shared equitably and stewarded sustainably.

这个句子的句型值得大家在写作中借鉴，句子结构的主谓其实就是 fierce debates/ rage in Seoul，后面的 over ...都是关于 debate 内容的定语。笔者之所以这么放置，主要是为了平衡句子重量，如果写成 How to ensure... rages in Seoul，主语过长，读起来喘不过气；后置后，主干 (Debates rage) 先声夺人，细节 (over ...) 后补。

类似用来平衡句子结构的句型还包括：

It soon emerged that (it 形式主语+谓语+that 主语从句)

neither the July nor August mortgage payment had been collected. 很快显示的是 7 月和 8 月的抵押款都没有被收取。

Para.7 Overall tax revenue is projected to reach 500trn won next year, equal to 17% of GDP and a record high.

be projected to do sth 属于被动语态，意为“被预估/预测会”，这种暗含“是有根据的，例如以往数据等，并非胡乱猜测”，常见于正式写作，例句：A growth rate of 4% is projected for next year. 预计明年的增长率为 4%。

类似表达还有：

u be estimated to do “被估测会” (同样较为客观理性地预测)，例：The deal is estimated to be worth around \$1.5 million. 这笔交易估计价值 150 万元左右。

u be expected to do “被预期” (一般，可能性不太高)，例：House prices are expected to rise sharply. 预计房价会急剧上涨。

分配企业股份。

【Para.10】

Others see such calls as misguided. Chipmaking requires continuous investment: new levies could discourage it. The public's claim to revenues generated by private-sector electronics firms is not **akin** to its right to benefit from nationally owned oil and gas companies—even if some in South Korea like to compare them. It is true that AI labs have trained their models using data created by whole societies. But that is not the game South Korea's chipmakers are in, says Rhee Chang-yong, a former

governor of the Bank of Korea: "They benefit from AI, but they are not AI."

另一些人则认为这种主张有失妥当。芯片制造需要持续投资，新设税种可能抑制投资。公众对私营电子企业所产生收入的主张，并不等同于其对国有石油和天然气公司收益的享有权——尽管部分韩国人喜欢将两者相提并论。AI实验室确实利用整个社会产生的数据来训练模型，但韩国芯片制造商并不从事这一领域。韩国银行前总裁李昌镛（Rhee Chang yong）表示：“它们虽受益于AI，但本身并非AI。”